ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE M

Vote NO on the 1% Clayton Sales Tax. We sent a message in June. Now, let's stand firm in November.

- In June 2026, Clayton residents joined voters across Contra Costa County to decisively defeat Measure B, a 0.625% sales tax hike. **In Clayton, 69% of voters wisely said NO to Measure B.**
- The message from our community was clear: inflation and the cost of living are hurting families, and we cannot afford more taxes. Yet, just weeks later, the Clayton City Council voted 5-0 to push an even larger 1% tax increase onto the November ballot.
- This proposal **ignores the clear financial mandate** Clayton citizens just delivered at the polls.
- Clayton's overall sales tax rate is an already high 8.75%; **Measure M would spike that rate to 9.75%,** punishing working families and fixed-income seniors. **If Measure RTM also passes, our total rate would reach 10.25%.**

Fuel Staff Pay Hikes:

- Our politicians have **no set agreement** for how the proposed tax hike will be used.
- Ultimately, this revenue increase to the general fund will likely be absorbed by rising city salaries, continuing to leave deferred infrastructure neglected and triggering future tax hikes to pay for actual community needs.

A Losing Compensation Race:

- Government salaries and employee benefits have risen significantly since the pandemic, while the private sector faces layoffs. Between 2019 and 2025, total Clayton employee compensation rose 37%, well ahead of Bay Area consumer price inflation.
- Setting Clayton's small-town employee salaries to other city governments ensures that future spending will likely exceed revenues, requiring more tax increases.

No End in Sight:

- Unlike the failed Measure B, which was set to expire after 5 years, Clayton's Measure M is a **permanent** tax hike.
- Clayton government must learn to live within its means, just like Clayton families do every single day.

Keep Clayton Sensible. **Vote NO on Measure M.**

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the Primary Argument Against Measure M at the General Election for Contra Costa County, to be held on 11/3/26, hereby state that this argument is true and correct to the best of (his/her/their) knowledge and belief.

1) Name, Title: Marc Joffe, Contra Costa Taxpayers Association, President

Signature: Marc Joffe

2) Name, Title: James Killoran, Credit Union Supervisory Committee Chair, Clayton

Signature: Jms Killorn

3) Name, Title: Allison Snow, Retired Healthcare Executive, Clayton

Signature:

4) Name, Title: Nancy Topp, CPA/CFO, Clayton

Signature: Nancy Topp

5) Name, Title: Bill Calkins, Clayton Resident

Signature: Bill Calkins